

The Holy Eucharist Rite II
Eighteenth Sunday After Pentecost
September 27, 2026

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Hymn at the Procession: **#450 - "All Hail the Power of Jesus' Name!"**

Celebrant: Blessed be God: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

People: **And blessed be his kingdom, now and for ever. Amen.**

The Celebrant says;

Almighty God, to you all hearts are open, all desires known, and from you no secrets are hid; Cleanse the thoughts of our hearts by the inspiration of your Holy Spirit, that we may perfectly love you, and worthily magnify your holy Name; through Christ our Lord. *Amen.*

Gloria: Hymnal - S280

Celebrant: The Lord be with you.

People: **And also with you.**

Celebrant: Let us pray.

Collect of the Day: O God, you declare your almighty power chiefly in showing mercy and pity: Grant us the fullness of your grace, that we, running to obtain your promises, may become partakers of your heavenly treasure; through Jesus Christ our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. **Amen.**

Exodus 17:1-7

From the wilderness of Sin the whole congregation of the Israelites journeyed by stages, as the Lord commanded. They camped at Rephidim, but there was no water for the people to drink. The people quarreled with Moses, and said, “Give us water to drink.” Moses said to them, “Why do you quarrel with me? Why do you test the Lord?” But the people thirsted there for water; and the people complained against Moses and said, “Why did you bring us out of Egypt, to kill us and our children and livestock with thirst?” So Moses cried out to the Lord, “What shall I do with this people? They are almost ready to stone me.” The Lord said to Moses, “Go on ahead of the people, and take some of the elders of Israel with you; take in your hand the staff with which you struck the Nile, and go. I will be standing there in front of you on the rock at Horeb. Strike the rock, and water will come out of it, so that the people may drink.” Moses did so, in the sight of the elders of Israel. He called the place Massah and Meribah, because the Israelites quarreled and tested the Lord, saying, “Is the Lord among us or not?”

The Word of the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

Psalm 78:1-4, 12-16

1 Hear my teaching, O my people; *
incline your ears to the words of my mouth.

2 I will open my mouth in a parable; *
I will declare the mysteries of ancient times.

3 That which we have heard and known,
and what our forefathers have told us, *
we will not hide from their children.

4 We will recount to generations to come
the praiseworthy deeds and the power of the Lord, *
and the wonderful works he has done.

12 He worked marvels in the sight of their forefathers, *
in the land of Egypt, in the field of Zoan.

13 He split open the sea and let them pass through; *
he made the waters stand up like walls.

14 He led them with a cloud by day, *
and all the night through with a glow of fire.

15 He split the hard rocks in the wilderness *
and gave them drink as from the great deep.

16 He brought streams out of the cliff, *
and the waters gushed out like rivers.

A Reading from the Letter of Paul to the Philippians

Philippians 2:1-13

If then there is any encouragement in Christ, any consolation from love, any sharing in the Spirit, any compassion and sympathy, make my joy complete: be of the same mind, having the same love, being in full accord and of one mind. Do nothing from selfish ambition or conceit, but in humility regard others as better than yourselves. Let each of you look not to your own interests, but to the interests of others. Let the same mind be in you that was in Christ Jesus, who, though he was in the form of God, did not regard equality with God as something to be exploited, but emptied himself, taking the form of a slave, being born in human likeness. And being found in human form, he humbled himself and became obedient to the point of death-- even death on a cross. Therefore God also highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bend, in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. Therefore, my beloved, just as you have always obeyed me, not only in my presence, but much more now in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling; for it is God who is at work in you, enabling you both to will and to work for his good pleasure.

The word of the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

Sequence Hymn: #339 - "Deck Thyself, My Soul, with Gladness"

The Holy Gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ according to St. Matthew
Glory to you, Lord Christ.

Matthew 21:23-32

When Jesus entered the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came to him as he was teaching, and said, “By what authority are you doing these things, and who gave you this authority?” Jesus said to them, “I will also ask you one question; if you tell me the answer, then I will also tell you by what authority I do these things. Did the baptism of John come from heaven, or was it of human origin?” And they argued with one another, “If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will say to us, ‘Why then did you not believe him?’ But if we say, ‘Of human origin,’ we are afraid of the crowd; for all regard John as a prophet.” So they answered Jesus, “We do not know.” And he said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things.

“What do you think? A man had two sons; he went to the first and said, ‘Son, go and work in the vineyard today.’ He answered, ‘I will not’; but later he changed his mind and went. The father went to the second and said the same; and he answered, ‘I go, sir’; but he did not go. Which of the two did the will of his father?” They said, “The first.” Jesus said to them, “Truly I tell you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes are going into the kingdom of God ahead of you. For John came to you in the way of righteousness and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him; and even after you saw it, you did not change your minds and believe him.”

The Gospel of the Lord.
Praise to you, Lord Christ.

The Sermon - The Rev. Stuart Hoke

The Nicene Creed

**We believe in one God,
the Father, the Almighty,
maker of heaven and earth,
of all that is, seen and unseen.**

**We believe in one Lord, Jesus Christ,
the only Son of God,
eternally begotten of the Father,
God from God, Light from Light,
true God from true God,
begotten, not made,
of one Being with the Father.
Through him all things were made.**

**For us and for our salvation
he came down from heaven:
by the power of the Holy Spirit
he became incarnate from the Virgin Mary,
and was made man.
For our sake he was crucified under Pontius Pilate;
he suffered death and was buried.**

**On the third day he rose again
in accordance with the Scriptures;
he ascended into heaven
and is seated at the right hand of the Father.
He will come again in glory to judge the living and the dead,
and his kingdom will have no end.**

**We believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of life,
who proceeds from the Father and the Son.
With the Father and the Son he is worshiped and glorified.
He has spoken through the Prophets.
We believe in one holy catholic and apostolic Church.
We acknowledge one baptism for the forgiveness of sins.
We look for the resurrection of the dead,
and the life of the world to come. Amen.**

The Prayers of the People

Sisters and Brothers, in humility, regard others as better than yourselves. Humbly then, let us approach our God, saying, “To will and work for your good pleasure, O Lord, enable us.”

(1) Christ Jesus, strengthen our tongues to declare you as Lord of our lives. May we, your Church, glorify your Heavenly Parent in word and deed.

Silence

To will and work for your good pleasure,

O Lord, enable us.

(2) Christ Jesus, you choose not to exploit your equality with God, but humbled yourself to be with us. Give us your heart for the marginalized and poor. And may all people, especially those in power, follow your example of humility.

Silence

To will and work for your good pleasure,

O Lord, enable us.

(3) Christ Jesus, by your birth in human likeness, you blessed all of creation. Remind us that your feet have trod our soil and tasted our waters. Give us the will to care for this precious planet.

Silence

To will and work for your good pleasure,

O Lord, enable us.

(4) Christ Jesus, you rule the world with love and compassion. Give to our local leaders compassion and vision that the people of our region might live as neighbors, looking out for each other’s interests.

Silence

To will and work for your good pleasure,

O Lord, enable us.

(5) Christ Jesus, you became obedient to the point of death that we might have abundant life. Work marvels in the lives of the sick and sorrowful. May they recount to generations the wonderful deeds you have done in their lives.

Silence

To will and work for your good pleasure,

O Lord, enable us. Amen.

Confession of Sin BCP 360

Let us confess our sins against God and our neighbor.

Silence may be kept.

Minister and People

Most merciful God,

we confess that we have sinned against you

in thought, word, and deed,

by what we have done,

and by what we have left undone.

We have not loved you with our whole heart;

we have not loved our neighbors as ourselves.

We are truly sorry and we humbly repent.

For the sake of your Son Jesus Christ,

have mercy on us and forgive us;

that we may delight in your will,

and walk in your ways,

to the glory of your Name. Amen.

The Bishop, when present, or the Priest, stands and says

Almighty God have mercy on you, forgive you all your sins

through our Lord Jesus Christ, strengthen you in all

goodness, and by the power of the Holy Spirit keep you in

eternal life. *Amen.*

Absolution

The peace of the Lord be always with you.

And also with you.

Celebrant: Walk in love, as Christ loved us, and gave himself for us, an offering and sacrifice to God.

Doxology

Old 100th Verse 3

Hymnal 380

The Holy Eucharist II

Eucharistic Prayer A ... Page 361

The Lord be with you.

And also with you.

Lift up your hearts.

We lift them to the Lord.

Let us give thanks to the Lord our God.

It is right to give our thanks and praise.

It is right, and a good and joyful thing, always and everywhere to give thanks to you, Father Almighty, Creator of heaven and earth.

For you are the source of light and life, you made us in your image, and called us to new life in Jesus Christ our Lord.

Therefore we praise you, joining our voices with Angels and Archangels and with all the company of heaven, who for ever say this hymn to proclaim the glory of your Name:

**Holy, Holy, Holy Lord, God of power and might,
heaven and earth are full of your glory.**

Hosanna in the highest.

Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.

Hosanna in the highest.

Holy and gracious Father: In your infinite love you made us for yourself, and, when we had fallen into sin and become subject to evil and death, you, in your mercy, sent Jesus Christ, your only and eternal Son, to share our human nature, to live and die as one of us, to reconcile us to you, the God and Father of all.

He stretched out his arms upon the cross, and offered himself, in obedience to your will, a perfect sacrifice for the whole world.

On the night he was handed over to suffering and death, our Lord Jesus Christ took bread; and when he had given thanks to you, he broke it, and gave it to his disciples, and said, "Take, eat: This is my Body, which is given for you. Do this for the remembrance of me."

After supper he took the cup of wine; and when he had given thanks, he gave it to them, and said, "Drink this, all of you: This is my Blood of the new Covenant, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. Whenever you drink it, do this for the remembrance of me."

Therefore we proclaim the mystery of faith:

Celebrant and People

Christ has died.

Christ is risen.

Christ will come again.

The Celebrant continues

We celebrate the memorial of our redemption, O Father, in this sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving. Recalling his death, resurrection, and ascension, we offer you these gifts.

Sanctify them by your Holy Spirit to be for your people the Body and Blood of your Son, the holy food and drink of new and unending life in him. Sanctify us also that we may faithfully receive this holy Sacrament, and serve you in unity, constancy, and peace; and at the last day bring us with all your saints into the joy of your eternal kingdom.

All this we ask through your Son Jesus Christ: By him, and with him, and in him, in the unity of the Holy Spirit all honor and glory is yours, Almighty Father, now and for ever. *AMEN.*

And now, as our Savior

Christ has taught us,

we are bold to say,

Our Father, who art in heaven,

hallowed be thy Name,

thy kingdom come,

thy will be done,

on earth as it is in heaven.

Give us this day our daily bread.

And forgive us our trespasses,
as we forgive those
who trespass against us.
And lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kingdom,
and the power, and the glory,
for ever and ever. Amen.

The Bread is broken.

The Gifts of God for the People of God.
Take them in remembrance that Christ died for
you, and feed on him in your hearts by faith,
with thanksgiving.

(Prayer after Communion)

Let us pray.

**Eternal God, heavenly Father,
you have graciously accepted us as living members
of your Son our Savior Jesus Christ,
and you have fed us with spiritual food
in the Sacrament of his Body and Blood.
Send us now into the world in peace,
and grant us strength and courage
to love and serve you
with gladness and singleness of heart;
through Christ our Lord. Amen**

(A prayer for Spiritual Communion)

Lord Jesus,

I believe that you are truly present
in the Holy Sacrament of the Altar.

I love you above all things,
and long for you in my soul.

Since I cannot now receive you sacramentally,
come at least spiritually into my heart
that I may welcome your presence with joy.
I embrace you and unite myself entirely to you.
Let me never be separated from you. **Amen.**

The Blessing:

Hymn : **#344 - "Lord, Dismiss Us with Thy Blessing"**

Let us go forth in the name of Christ.

Thanks be to God. Alleluia! Alleluia!

Postlude



We welcome everyone to Church of the Epiphany today, especially our new guests. Please let us know if you'd like more information about the church. You are invited to join us for Holy Communion*. Gluten free wafers are available on request.

The offering plate is behind the last pew. Your gifts and tithes support our ministries in the community.

Worship Resources:

- BCP –“Book of Common Prayer”-Red or black book w/cross
- Hymnal –“The Hymnal 1982” – Red or Blue book
- WLP –“Wonder Love and Praise” - Green book
- LEVAS –“Lift Every Voice and Sing” - Red and black book

*If you do not wish to drink from the chalice at communion, cross your arms in front of your chest, or return to your seat after you receive the bread. We no longer practice dipping the bread into the cup.

The Most Rev. Sean Rowe, *Presiding Bishop*
The Rt. Rev. Samuel Rodman, *Bishop Diocesan*
The Rt. Rev. Jennifer Brooke-Davidson, *Assistant Bishop*
Ms. Ronda Proffit, *Organist & Choir Director*
Mrs. Carol Echols, *Parish Administrator*
Mr. Rob Martin, *Treasurer*

Vestry

Jimmy Ivie, Sr. Warden, Jo Sherwood, Jr. Warden
Donna Turner, Elizabeth Treadwell, Deb Foddrell, Caysey Petty, Jill Dineen,
Deb Norton, Helen Knight

The Vestry persons of the Month of September are Helen Knight and Deb Norton

Our Lay Reader this morning is Elizabeth Treadwell

Announcements

**The Altar Flowers given to the glory of God and in thanksgiving honoring
Epiphany's founding Parishioners.**

**Join us after the service today for our Vestry Coffee Hour and Planning Session for
Epiphany's 180th Homecoming Celebration!**

**We need your ideas and creativity to choose the date, design the invitation, build the guest
list, plan social media outreach,
select special music and showcase 180 years of service to our community.**

Join us for delicious food, fellowship, and a celebration of all things Epiphany!

To place flowers on the altar, sign the altar flower chart located in the Narthex. You may provide them yourself, or you may call Carol in the church office to order through the florist. You may also purchase an aumbry candle in honor or memory of a loved one

Birthdays

Sept.	27	Sarah Tucker
	27	William Ivie
Oct.	1	Judy Rouse
	1	Maria Wilson
	3	Joe Sherwood, Jr.
	3	Ed Hankins

Current Prayer List

All victims of war, violence of every kind, and natural disasters. Healing for our country. For our military, and all who put themselves in harm's way to protect us.

Babby D., Lyn Seymour, Lori, Danny Williams, Dawn, Vivian Smith, Darlene Harper, Jack and John, Sandi J., Skip J., Crystal Scott, Jim Pyron, Lois Clark, Frank Ferguson, Dorothy Gunn,

As you pray for those on the prayer list, please let the church office know if any names may be removed from the list. After 4 weeks, names are moved to the Long-Term Prayer List. Let us know if names can be removed from that list as well.